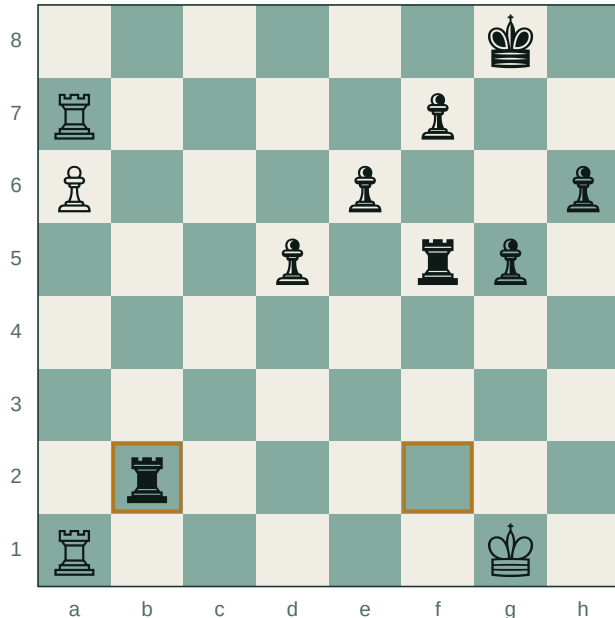


Promotion combinations: White, move 43

Promotion combinations

White to move



Previous move: 42...Rb2. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

43. Rb7 Re2 44. a7 Rff2 45. a8=Q+

43.Rb7 The rook moves from a7 to b7. Recorded reply: **43...Re2**.

44.a7 The pawn moves from a6 to a7. Recorded reply: **44...Rff2**.

45.a8=Q+ Check restricts Black to 2 legal replies here. The pawn becomes a queen.

At the end, nominal material is White 19 / Black 15 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, White's balance changes by +8. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does White's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** +8: the balance goes from -4 to +4. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

Always inspect stalemate and underpromotion resources. A queen is usually strongest, but the exact position determines the choice.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

An advanced pawn can turn a tactical sequence into a new queen or another useful piece. Promotion may occur with capture or check, and the choice of piece can change the outcome.

HOW TO LOOK

Calculate the pawn's route, the safety of the promotion square, and whether the new piece can survive or give a decisive check.

The defending king is on g8. Geometrically undefended: rook on b2. Check for tactical protection.